SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #56 · FEAR AND THE NEWS

"The world is getting worse and worse."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

News thrives on alarm, and a steady feed of tragedy gives the impression that everything is collapsing. Older generations may say, "It was better in my day." Anxiety rises and joy and hope fade.

What Scripture teaches

Solomon wrote, "What has been will be again, and what has been done will be done again; there is nothing new under the sun," and cautioned that it is unwise to ask why the old days were better than these (Ecclesiastes 7:10). Jesus said, "In the world you will have tribulation. But take courage; I have overcome the world!" Paul wrote that "in the last days terrible times will come," so Christians are not surprised by trouble. But we are called to live with courage and hope, trusting God, who holds everything together.

> *"I have told you these things so that in Me you may have peace. In the world you will have tribulation. But take courage; I have overcome the world!"* (John 16:33).

Also see

> "What has been will be again, and what has been done will be done again; there is nothing new under the sun" (Ecclesiastes 1:9).

> "Do not say, 'Why were the old days better than these?' For it is unwise of you to ask about this" (Ecclesiastes 7:10).

> "But understand this: In the last days terrible times will come" (2 Timothy 3:1).

> "He is before all things, and in Him all things hold together" (Colossians 1:17).

Common self-statements

- Everything is falling apart.
- It is worse than ever.
- There is no good news.
- The future looks dark.
- I cannot stand to watch.
- Nothing is safe anymore.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing the world as only getting worse.
- Mind reading: Assuming the worst is typical.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling alarmed and concluding that it must be catastrophic.
- Fortune telling: Predicting more collapse.

Challenging questions

- What news sources am I taking in, and how often?
- What good is happening that I do not hear about?
- What did people in earlier generations face?

- What does Jesus promise in a troubled world?
- What helps me stay informed without being overwhelmed?
- What good can I do near me?

Truth summary

> Trouble is real, but Jesus has overcome the world. I can stay informed in moderation, notice what is good, and hold onto hope and courage.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Anxiety/Worry
- Fear
- Worldly
- Hopeless
- Peace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Anxiety/Worry/Fear

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "The world is getting worse and worse"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"The world is getting worse and worse." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What news do I take in?
- ☐ What good am I missing?
- ☐ What did earlier generations face?
- ☐ What does Jesus promise?
- ☐ How can I stay informed calmly?
- ☐ What good can I do?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Jesus has overcome the world.
- ☐ Trouble has always existed.
- ☐ God holds all things together.
- ☐ I can take courage.
- ☐ Good is also happening.
- ☐ I can limit what I take in.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ John 16:33
  "I have told you these things so that in Me you may have peace. In the world you will have tribulation. But take courage; I have overcome the world!"
- ☐ Ecclesiastes 1:9
  "What has been will be again, and what has been done will be done again; there is nothing new under the sun."
- ☐ Colossians 1:17
  "He is before all things, and in Him all things hold together."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Courage and good news: Each week, note three good things you noticed.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, John 16:33 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Jesus has overcome the world, so I can take courage.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Fear" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Set news limits. Check news at set times.
- ☐ Collect good news. Write three good things each day.
- ☐ Do one good thing. Help someone near you.
- ☐ Memorize John 16:33. Say it when you feel alarmed.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "The world is getting worse and worse": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Courage and good news
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~The world is getting worse and worse.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, the news weighs on me. Thank You that You have overcome the world. Give me courage, hope, and a heart to do good where I am. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #57 · FEAR AND THE NEWS

“I can never be safe.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Trauma, accidents, crime, illness, or frightening events can convince the mind that danger is everywhere. The body stays on alert, and the world feels like a minefield. We may avoid places, people, and activities to stay safe.

What Scripture teaches

“He who dwells in the shelter of the Most High will abide in the shadow of the Almighty,” and the psalmist calls the LORD his refuge and fortress. “I will lie down and sleep in peace, for You alone, O LORD, make me dwell in safety.” “When you pass through the waters, I will be with you.” “The LORD will guard you from all evil; He will preserve your soul.” Scripture does not promise a life with no harm, but it promises God’s presence and ultimate safety in Him.

> *“He who dwells in the shelter of the Most High will abide in the shadow of the Almighty. I will say to the LORD, ‘You are my refuge and my fortress, my God, in whom I trust.’”* (Psalm 91:1–2).

Also see

> “I will lie down and sleep in peace, for You alone, O LORD, make me dwell in safety” (Psalm 4:8).

> “When you pass through the waters, I will be with you; and when you go through the rivers, they will not overwhelm you. When you walk through the fire, you will not be scorched; the flames will not set you ablaze” (Isaiah 43:2).

> “The LORD will guard you from all evil; He will preserve your soul. The LORD will watch over your coming and going, both now and forevermore” (Psalm 121:7–8).

> “God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in times of trouble. Therefore we will not fear, though the earth is transformed and the mountains are toppled into the depths of the seas” (Psalm 46:1–2).

Common self-statements

- Danger is everywhere.
- Something bad will happen.
- I cannot relax.
- Nowhere is safe.
- I cannot protect myself or my family.
- I have to watch constantly.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing things are either perfectly safe or dangerous.
- Mind reading: Assuming danger is likely.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling afraid and concluding that I am in danger.
- Fortune telling: Predicting harm.

Challenging questions

- What happened that taught me danger is everywhere?
- What is the actual likelihood of what I fear?
- Where do I feel safe, even a little?
- What does Scripture say about God's presence in danger?
- What would help my body calm down?
- Who could help me, such as a counselor?

Truth summary

> I live in a world with real risks, but I am not alone. God is my refuge, and I can take wise precautions without living on alert. Healing from trauma is possible with support.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Fear
- Anxiety/Worry
- Peace
- Sleep Problems
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I can never be safe"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I can never be safe." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What taught me this?
- ☐ How likely is it?
- ☐ Where do I feel safe?
- ☐ What does Scripture say?
- ☐ What calms my body?
- ☐ Who can help?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God is my refuge and fortress.
- ☐ I can lie down and sleep in peace.
- ☐ God is with me through the waters.
- ☐ He guards my coming and going.
- ☐ Wise caution is enough.
- ☐ Healing is possible.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 91:1–2
  "He who dwells in the shelter of the Most High will abide in the shadow of the Almighty. I will say to the LORD, 'You are my refuge and my fortress, my God, in whom I trust.'"
- ☐ Psalm 4:8
  "I will lie down and sleep in peace, for You alone, O LORD, make me dwell in safety."
- ☐ Isaiah 43:2
  "When you pass through the waters, I will be with you; and when you go through the rivers, they will not overwhelm you. When you walk through the fire, you will not be scorched; the flames will not set you ablaze."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Safe in His presence: Each day, note one moment you felt safe and thank God.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 4:8 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord alone makes me dwell in safety.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Fear" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Name triggers. Write what sets off the alarm.
- [ ] Practice calming. Breathe slowly and ground yourself.
- [ ] Pray Psalm 4:8. Say it at bedtime.
- [ ] Get support. If trauma is behind this, talk with a counselor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I can never be safe": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Safe in His presence
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I can never be safe.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, my body stays on guard. Be my refuge and my fortress. Teach me to rest in Your presence and to take wise steps without living in fear. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #58 · FEAR AND THE NEWS

“Terrible things are about to happen to me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

After loss, a bad diagnosis, trauma, or a pattern of anxious thinking, the mind keeps scanning for the next blow. Sleep and concentration suffer, and the future feels like a threat.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus said, “Therefore do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself. Today has enough trouble of its own.” “Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you.” “Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus.” “Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you.” We cannot control the future, but we can trust the One who holds it.

> *“Therefore do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself. Today has enough trouble of its own”* (Matthew 6:34).

Also see

> “Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness” (Isaiah 41:10).

> “Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus” (Philippians 4:6–7).

> “Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you” (1 Peter 5:7).

> “When I am afraid, I put my trust in You. In God, whose word I praise— in God I trust. I will not be afraid. What can man do to me?” (Psalm 56:3–4).

Common self-statements

- Something awful is coming.
- I can feel it.
- I always get bad news.
- I cannot relax.
- I am waiting for the other shoe to drop.
- I will not be able to handle it.

Common logical errors

- Catastrophizing: Expecting the worst.
- Fortune telling: Predicting disaster without evidence.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling dread and concluding that danger is coming.
- Mental filter: Focusing on threats and ignoring what is going well.

Challenging questions

- What specifically do I fear?
- How often have my worst predictions come true?
- What has God brought me through before?
- What is happening now that is okay?
- What does Scripture say about worry?
- What can I do today about this fear?

Truth summary

> I cannot predict the future, and most feared things never happen. God is with me and will help me with what comes, one day at a time. I can bring my fears to Him and receive His peace.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Anxiety/Worry
- Fear
- Peace
- Trust
- Thinking, Unhealthy

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

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Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Terrible things are about to happen to me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Terrible things are about to happen to me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I fear?
- ☐ How often has it come true?
- ☐ What has God brought me through?
- ☐ What is okay now?
- ☐ What does Scripture say?
- ☐ What can I do today?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Today has enough trouble of its own.
- ☐ God is with me.
- ☐ He will strengthen and help me.
- ☐ His peace will guard my heart.
- ☐ He cares for me.
- ☐ I can face today.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Matthew 6:34**
  "Therefore do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself. Today has enough trouble of its own."
- ☐ **Isaiah 41:10**
  "Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness."
- ☐ **Philippians 4:6–7**
  "Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] One day at a time: Each week, note one fear that did not come true.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Matthew 6:34 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I will not worry about tomorrow. God is with me today.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Anxiety/Worry" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Write the fear. Describe it and how likely it is.
- [ ] Track predictions. Keep a log of fears and outcomes.
- [ ] Pray Philippians 4:6–7. Present each worry to God.
- [ ] Return to today. Do one useful thing now.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Terrible things are about to happen to me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One day at a time
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Terrible things are about to happen to me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, my mind runs ahead to disasters. Thank You that You are with me today. Give me Your peace, and help me trust You with tomorrow. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #59 · FEAR AND THE NEWS

"I must stay on guard all the time."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Past betrayal, trauma, or a chaotic home taught that relaxing leads to harm. Hypervigilance feels like protection, but it exhausts the body and mind, strains relationships, and keeps us from rest.

What Scripture teaches

Psalm 127 reminds us that unless the LORD guards the city, the watchman stays alert in vain. Scripture also says, "The LORD will guard you from all evil... The LORD will watch over your coming and going." "You will keep in perfect peace the steadfast of mind, because he trusts in You." "I will lie down and sleep in peace, for You alone, O LORD, make me dwell in safety." Wise caution is good, but constant guarding is a burden God did not design us to carry. He is the One who never slumbers.

> *"You will keep in perfect peace the steadfast of mind, because he trusts in You"* (Isaiah 26:3).

Also see

> "The LORD will guard you from all evil; He will preserve your soul. The LORD will watch over your coming and going, both now and forevermore" (Psalm 121:7–8).

> "I will lie down and sleep in peace, for You alone, O LORD, make me dwell in safety" (Psalm 4:8).

> "Do not fear sudden danger or the ruin that overtakes the wicked, for the LORD will be your confidence and will keep your foot from the snare" (Proverbs 3:25–26).

> "Let the peace of Christ rule in your hearts, for to this you were called as members of one body. And be thankful" (Colossians 3:15).

Common self-statements

- If I relax, something bad happens.
- I have to watch everything.
- Letting my guard down is dangerous.
- Peace is naive.
- I am the only protector.
- I am always bracing.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must be on guard or unsafe.
- Mind reading: Assuming danger around every corner.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling tense and concluding that danger is near.
- Fortune telling: Predicting harm if I relax.

Challenging questions

- What taught me to stay on guard?
- What has constant vigilance cost me?

- What actual dangers need attention, and what do not?
- What does it mean that God watches over me?
- What helps my body relax?
- Who or what is safe enough to rest with?

Truth summary

> God watches over me, so I do not have to watch alone. I can use wise caution where needed and practice rest. Perfect peace comes from trusting Him.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Peace
- Anxiety/Worry
- Sleep Problems
- Tired
- Fear

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

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Songs that speak truth to this belief

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Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

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Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I must stay on guard all the time"

✦ ✦ ✦

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Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I must stay on guard all the time." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What taught me this?
- ☐ What has it cost?
- ☐ What dangers are real?
- ☐ What does God's watching mean?
- ☐ What helps me relax?
- ☐ Where can I rest?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God watches over my coming and going.
- ☐ He keeps me in perfect peace.
- ☐ I can sleep in peace.
- ☐ The Lord is my confidence.
- ☐ I can use wise caution and rest.
- ☐ I am not the only protector.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Isaiah 26:3
  "You will keep in perfect peace the steadfast of mind, because he trusts in You."
- ☐ Psalm 121:7–8
  "The LORD will guard you from all evil; He will preserve your soul. The LORD will watch over your coming and going, both now and forevermore."
- ☐ Psalm 4:8
  "I will lie down and sleep in peace, for You alone, O LORD, make me dwell in safety."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Rest in His watch: Each day, practice five minutes of rest and thank God for watching over you.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Isaiah 26:3 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God keeps me in perfect peace when I trust in Him.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Peace" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Notice the guard. Write when your body tenses.
- ☐ Practice rest. Breathe, stretch, or pray for five minutes.
- ☐ Sort dangers. List real risks and imagined ones.
- ☐ Seek help. If this comes from trauma, talk with a counselor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I must stay on guard all the time": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Rest in His watch
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I must stay on guard all the time.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I am tired of standing guard. You never slumber. Teach me to trust Your watching and to rest in Your peace. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #60 · FEAR AND THE NEWS

“I can't trust anybody.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Betrayal by a parent, spouse, friend, church leader, or institution can convince us that everyone will eventually hurt us. We keep people at arm’s length. Safe, but alone.

What Scripture teaches

“Cursed is the man who trusts in mankind… But blessed is the man who trusts in the LORD, whose confidence is in Him.” “It is better to take refuge in the LORD than to trust in man.” Yet Scripture also shows trustworthy people: “Two are better than one,” and “As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another.” Jesus told His disciples, “be as shrewd as snakes and as innocent as doves.” Trust is not all or nothing. It can be given in small steps, to people who show themselves reliable, while our deepest trust rests in God.

> *“It is better to take refuge in the LORD than to trust in man”* (Psalm 118:8).

Also see

> “This is what the LORD says: ‘Cursed is the man who trusts in mankind, who makes the flesh his strength and turns his heart from the LORD. He will be like a shrub in the desert; he will not see when prosperity comes. He will dwell in the parched places of the desert, in a salt land where no one lives. But blessed is the man who trusts in the LORD, whose confidence is in Him.’” (Jeremiah 17:5–7).

> “Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!” (Ecclesiastes 4:9–10).

> “As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another” (Proverbs 27:17).

> “Behold, I am sending you out like sheep among wolves; therefore be as shrewd as snakes and as innocent as doves” (Matthew 10:16).

Common self-statements

- Everyone lets me down.
- If I trust, I will be hurt.
- People cannot be relied on.
- I am safer alone.
- I will never open up again.
- They all have an agenda.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing people are either fully trustworthy or not at all.
- Mind reading: Assuming betrayal.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling hurt and concluding that no one is safe.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will be hurt again.

Challenging questions

- Who betrayed my trust, and what happened?

- Has anyone proven reliable, even in small ways?
- What would trust in small steps look like?
- What do I lose by trusting no one?
- What does Scripture say about trusting God and people?
- Who could help me heal from the betrayal?

Truth summary

> Some people hurt me, but not everyone will. My deepest trust belongs to God, who never fails, and I can give trust slowly to those who prove reliable. Healing makes room for safe relationships.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Trust
- Forgiveness
- Loneliness
- Friendship
- Wisdom

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Death and Dying
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I can't trust anybody"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I can't trust anybody." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who betrayed me?
- ☐ Who is reliable?
- ☐ What small step?
- ☐ What do I lose?
- ☐ What does Scripture say?
- ☐ Who can help me heal?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Taking refuge in the Lord is better.
- ☐ God never fails.
- ☐ Two are better than one.
- ☐ Trust can be given in small steps.
- ☐ Not everyone will hurt me.
- ☐ Healing is possible.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 118:8
  "It is better to take refuge in the LORD than to trust in man."
- ☐ Ecclesiastes 4:9–10
  "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!"
- ☐ Proverbs 27:17
  "As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Small steps of trust: Each week, note one small trust you tried and how it went.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Psalm 118:8 becomes: "Sarah can write: "It is better to take refuge in the Lord than to trust in man.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Trust" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Name the betrayal. Write what happened and how it affected you.
- ☐ List reliable people. Note anyone who has proven trustworthy.
- ☐ Try a small trust. Share something small and watch the response.
- ☐ Seek healing. Consider counseling for betrayal wounds.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I can't trust anybody": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Small steps of trust
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I can't trust anybody.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I was hurt, and trusting is hard. You never fail. Heal my heart, give me discernment, and bring safe people into my life. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.